documents that revealed the rather shady behaviour of Landsbanki in Russia in the 1990s and 2000s. Three people had died during the transactions described in the dossier, and senior officials in Putin's government seemed to be have been involved in registering some of the various companies that had been created. I felt we were getting closer and closer to the point where we could force real openness on this mighty issue of the relationship between money and government. One of the first people I met there was the former CEO of the Kaupthing Bank – the one that had threated to imprison me for a year for revealing their loan book. That didn't go particularly well. Then I spoke to the *chargé d'affaire*, who was surrounded by three of those goons who seemed to have come direct from Central Casting. Looking at them, you had to wonder precisely what they had done in El Salvador to end up marooned in Iceland, where they spent the day monitoring the Chinese embassy. I showed some of the Russian Landsbanki documents to people I met there – why not? Openness is openness, right? – and you could see their eyes widen and their diplomatic hands reach out as if to snatch the documents away. It's amazing how stodgy those people are and how little they know about the world they're paid to interact with. Some months later, I released a cable sent by that same Charges d'Affaires I'd been chatting to and they went nuts, thinking that I'd somehow acquired it at the party.

The experience of developing the haven taught us a great deal about how to advance the WikiLeaks ethos into public policy. We did that not for reasons of ambition, as people say, but because it is the natural extension of speaking truth to power. Eventually, it would be nice to find common ground for the project and give it the apparatus of free states to support it. The Internet, in a sense, is a nation, but a nation of the imagination, where one is free to enter and leave without a passport. But it has its primitive aspects. While one is free to post on the Internet, one is not able to be protected by it: on a bad day, the Internet is the biggest surveillance tool in the world. It encourages a free press, but it offers the same encouragement to those who hate press freedom. That is the irony of the new technology, and one that we aimed to circumvent, giving our ideas of justice a legislative support network on terra firma. We learned much and met many people, including the aforementioned Kristinn Hrafnsson, an Icelandic journalist and activist who is now an important staff member at WikiLeaks.